



Yoonjeon Kim

PHD CANDIDATE, KAIST AI

Reinforcement Learning • Reasoning Models • Discrete Diffusion LMs

✉ yoonkim313@kaist.ac.kr • 🌐 akatigre • 🔗 LinkedIn • 🆔 ORCID

My research focuses on reinforcement learning (RL)-based post-training methods to enhance reasoning robustness in both language and multi-modal models. Specifically, I am exploring RL based fine-tuning techniques for large language models (LLMs), especially on diffusion-based language models for efficient and controllable generation.

- **Efficient RL-based Post-training:** Efficient Inferences in RL training for reasoning model.
- **Reasoning for Diffusion LMs:** Advance the reasoning ability of diffusion language models in a diffusion compatible way

PUBLICATIONS

Efficient Reinforcement for Visual-Textual Thinking with Discrete Diffusion Model

Under Review

YOONJEON KIM, YUHTA TAKIDA, CHIEH-HSIN LAI, EUNHO YANG, YUKI MITSUFUJI

[Paper]

Meta-Awareness Enhances Reasoning Models: Self-Alignment Reinforcement Learning

ICML 2026

YOONJEON KIM*, DOOHYUK JANG*, EUNHO YANG (*EQUAL CONTRIBUTION)

[Paper] [Code]

Reasoning Model is Stubborn: Diagnosing Instruction Overriding in Reasoning Models

Under Review

DOOHYUK JANG*, YOONJEON KIM*, CHANJAE PARK, HYUN RYU, EUNHO YANG (*EQUAL CONTRIBUTION)

[Paper] [Code] [Project Page]

Preserve or Modify? Context-Aware Evaluation for Balancing Preservation and Modification in Text-Guided Image Editing

CVPR 2025

YOONJEON KIM*, SOOHYUN RYU*, YEONSUNG JUNG, HYUNKOO LEE,

JOOWON KIM, JUNE YONG YANG, JAERYONG HWANG, EUNHO YANG (*EQUAL CONTRIBUTION)

[Paper] [Code] [Project Page]

Learning Input-Agnostic Manipulation Directions in StyleGAN with Text Guidance

ICLR 2023

YOONJEON KIM, HYUNSU KIM, JUNHO KIM, YUNJEY CHOI, EUNHO YANG

[Paper] [Code]

Sequential targeting: A continual learning approach for data imbalance in text classification

ESWA 2021

JOEL JANG, YOONJEON KIM, KYOUNGHO CHOI, SUNGHO SU

Journal of Expert System with Applications, Oct 2021.

[Paper]

PROJECT

A Study on Optimization and Network Interpretation Method for Large-Scale Machine Learning
NATIONAL RESEARCH FOUNDATION OF KOREA (NRF) GRANT FUNDED BY THE KOREA GOVERNMENT (MSIT)
Investigating optimization techniques and interpretability methods for large-scale machine learning models
Focus on scalable algorithms and transparency in deep neural networks

Mar.2024 - Feb.2027

Efficient Foundation Models on Intel Systems
INTEL CORPORATION & NAVER
Development of efficient and scalable foundation models optimized for Intel hardware platforms
Research on model compression, hardware-aware training, and deployment strategies

Sep 2024 - Aug 2025

Hyper-Scale AI Foundation Models
NAVER
Development of hyper-scale AI models for visual generative models

Sep 2021 - Aug 2023

EDUCATION

KAIST
PHD (CANDIDATE)
Major in Artificial Intelligence.
Advisor: Eunho Yang

Daejeon, South Korea
Mar.2023 - Dec.2026 (Anticipated)

KAIST
MASTER
Major in Artificial Intelligence.
Advisor: Eunho Yang

Daejeon, South Korea
Mar.2021 - Feb.2023

Yonsei University
BACHELOR
Major in Applied Statistics.
Full Scholarship

Seoul, South Korea
Mar.2017 - Feb.2021

INVITED TALKS

AI EXPO KOREA KAIST AI Tech Seminar
PRESENTER

KOEX, Seoul
2025

EXPERIENCE

Research Internship
SONY RESEARCH
Mentored by Yuhta Takida and Chieh-Hsin (Jesse) Lai.
• Multi-modal Discrete Diffusion Model.
• Reinforcement Learning on Multi-modal Reasoning.

Tokyo, Japan
Jan 2026 - June 2026 (Ongoing)

Internship, Machine Learning Researcher
NAVER CLOUD
Main achievements:
• 2D Casual Video to 3D Dynamic Neural Radiance Fields.
• 3D Reconstruction from Monocular Video with Generation Model.
• Pretrained Diffusion based NeRF Model Distillation.

Bundang, South Korea
Jul 2023 - Oct 2023